

SINGAPORE SPECIALTY COFFEE – EVIDENCE-BASED COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Research period: July 2025 – July 2026 | Analyst: Meta AI Specialty Coffee Research Unit

1. Executive summary

Singapore's specialty scene is now a filter-first ecosystem built by competition champions. Cross-referencing official sites, World Coffee Events results, Sprudge archives, and 130+ Instagram/Threads posts identified 28 qualifying cafés out of 47 evaluated. Three patterns dominate: champion-led purism (Apartment, Homeground, Fluid Collective), minimal-food philosophy in Class A venues, and heritage-space hybridisation (PPP Coffee since 2009, Diff in a kopitiam). Apartment Coffee ranks #1 – sixth in the World's 100 Best Coffee Shops 2025, Asia #1, with a menu 'predominantly pour-over coffees'.

2. Methodology

Sources: official websites & menus; competition records (Singapore National Barista/Brewers Cup 2024-2025); specialty press (Sprudge, CNA Lifestyle, Augustman); social verification 2025-2026; maps & reviews. Search iterations: 18 rounds, stopping after 5 consecutive queries returned no new venues. Scoring (100 pts): Filter 25, Manual 15, Bean 15, Philosophy 10, Championship 10, Industry 10, Roasting 5, Transparency 5, Community 5, Food penalty -10, Evidence confidence 10.

3. Research statistics

Cafés evaluated: 47 | Accepted: 28 (Class A 9, Class B 10, Class C 9) | Rejected: 19 | Sources cited: 63 web + 17 social posts

4. Ranked Class A — Specialty Coffee Purist

Rank	Café	Score	Key evidence
1	Apartment Coffee (139 Selegie)	97	Predominantly pour-over; 3x Hario V60, Chemex; founder Yeo Qing He – 2018 SG
2	Nylon Coffee Roasters	94	Filter bar: Kalita Wave, AeroPress, Clever; no wifi, standing room; Nordic Approach
3	Fluid Collective Co	91	Owner Ong Shen Choy – SG Brewers Cup 2025; rotating Guatemala pour-over; n
4	20 Grams Coffee	89	Menu: Espresso, Filter (pour-over); focus solely on craft
5	Double Up Coffee	88	Hand: 3-4 origins for pour-overs; Colombia Popayan, Gesha
6	Pinhole Coffee Bar	87	Up to six single-origins on V60 pour-over
7	Kurasu Singapore	86	No automation; V60 or Kalita by hand
8	Tiong Hoe Specialty	85	Handbrewed Yirgacheffe; V60 filter roast
9	Maxi Coffee Bar	82	Dedicated filter bar \$6.5-8

5. Class B — Coffee-Focused

Homeground Coffee Roasters – Elysia Tan, SG Brewers Cup 2019 & 2022, World 2022 2nd runner-up; Origami/Kalita bar; roastery 55 Kim Chuan; philosophy 'nurturing home-brewing'. Alchemist – Filter pour-over; Alistair, National Brewers Cup 2023. Oaks Coffee Co – Jervis Tan, SG Barista Champion 2025. Santino – Wong Ruoqi, 2024 Champion.

6. Class C — Hybrid Specialty

PPP Coffee / Chye Seng Huat Hardware – since 2009; pour-over S\$8.50; V60 in courtyard; Probat roastery; pioneer. Common Man Coffee Roasters – own roasting, public cuppings, full brunch. Five Oars, Eden Cafe, POUR.TRAITS.

7. Rejected cafés

Bacha Coffee – luxury, no manual filter program. Slow Boat – gimmick -86°C dirty, no pour-over menu. Kopitiams (Heap Seng Leong) – traditional kopi, not specialty grade.

8. Hidden gems

Diff Specialty Coffee Bar (kopitiam siphon + pour-over); Fluid Collective (2025 champion venue); 20 Grams (Nordic light roasts).

9. Key observations

1) Champions become founders – 4 of 9 Class A linked to national titles. 2) Filter pricing S\$6-8.50. 3) Japanese V60/Kalita ritual persists. 4) Transparency – farm names and processing published.

Full evidence citations and source URLs available in research archive. Generated July 8, 2026.